

Clinical Study Summary Report (CSSR)

Document Status: Final | Version: 1.0 | Date: 01-APR-2026

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title:	A Phase III Randomized Double-blind Study of Pembrolizumab Plus Best Supportive Care vs. Placebo Plus Best Supportive Care as Second-Line Therapy in Asian Subjects With Previously Systemically Treated Advanced Hepatocellular Carcinoma (KEYNOTE-394)
Short Title:	Study of Pembrolizumab (MK-3475) or Placebo Given With Best Supportive Care in Asian Participants With Previously Treated Advanced Hepatocellular Carcinoma (MK-3475-394/KEYNOTE-394)
Protocol Number:	541362913489557453
NCT Number:	NCT03062358
Sponsor Name:	Merck
Investigational Product:	pembrolizumab
Phase:	PHASE3
Medical Monitor:	[Not Provided in Posting]

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective

Primary Objective:	1. Overall Survival (OS): OS is the time from randomization to death due to any cause, based on the Kaplan-Meier method for censored data.
Secondary Obj.:	1. Progression Free Survival (PFS) Per Response Evaluation Criteria in Solid Tumors Version 1.1 (RECIST 1.1) 2. Objective Response Rate (ORR) Per Response Evaluation Criteria in Solid Tumors Version 1.1 (RECIST 1.1) 3. Duration Of Response (DOR) Per Response Evaluation Criteria in Solid Tumors Version 1.1 (RECIST 1.1)

2.2 Background & Rationale

The purpose of this study is to determine the efficacy and safety of pembrolizumab or placebo given with best supportive care (BSC) in Asian participants with previously systemically treated advanced hepatocellular carcinoma (HCC). The primary hypothesis of this study is that overall survival is prolonged in participants who receive pembrolizumab compared to those who receive placebo.

3. Study Design & Methodology

Design Framework:	Type: INTERVENTIONAL, Phase: PHASE3, Status: COMPLETED
Target N:	453

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria

* Has a HCC diagnosis confirmed by radiology, histology, or cytology (fibrolamellar, and mixed

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hepatocellular/cholangiocarcinoma subtypes are not eligible)

- * Has Barcelona Clinic Liver Cancer (BCLC) Stage C disease or BCLC Stage B disease not amenable to locoregional therapy or refractory to locoregional therapy and not amenable to a curative treatment approach.
- * Has a Child-Pugh A liver score within 7 days prior to first dose of study medication
- * Has a life expectancy of ≥ 3 months
- * Has at least one measurable lesion based on RECIST version 1.1 as determined by investigator.
- * Has Eastern Cooperative Oncology Group (ECOG) performance status of 0 or 1 performed within 7 days prior to receiving the first dose of study medication.
- * Has documented objective radiographic progression during or after treatment with sorafenib or oxaliplatin-based chemotherapy, or else intolerance to sorafenib or oxaliplatin-based chemotherapy
- * Female participants of childbearing potential must have a negative urine or serum pregnancy test within 72 hours prior to receiving the first dose of study therapy
- * Female and male participants of reproductive potential must agree to use adequate contraception starting from the first dose of study medication, throughout the study period, and for up to 120 days after the last dose of study medication

4.2 Exclusion Criteria

- * Is currently participating or has participated in a study with an investigational agent or using an investigational device within 4 weeks of the first dose of study medication
- * Has received sorafenib or oxaliplatin-based chemotherapy within 14 days of first dose of study medication
- * Has had esophageal or gastric variceal bleeding within the last 6 months
- * Has clinically apparent ascites on physical examination
- * Has portal vein invasion at the main portal branch (Vp4), inferior vena cava, or cardiac involvement of HCC based on imaging
- * Has had clinically diagnosed hepatic encephalopathy in the last 6 months
- * Has had a solid organ or hematologic transplant
- * Has had prior systemic therapy for HCC in the advanced (incurable) setting other than sorafenib or oxaliplatin-based chemotherapy, prior to start of study medication
- * Has an active autoimmune disease that has required systemic treatment in the past 2 years. Replacement therapy is not considered a form of systemic treatment.
- * Has a diagnosis of immunodeficiency or is receiving systemic steroid therapy or any other form of immunosuppressive therapy within 7 days prior to the first dose of study medication
- * Has received locoregional therapy to liver (transcatheter chemoembolization [TACE], transcatheter embolization [TAE], hepatic arterial infusion [HAI], radiation, radioembolization, or ablation) within 4 weeks prior to the first dose of study medication
- * Has had major surgery to liver or other site within 4 weeks prior to the first dose of study medication
- * Has had a minor surgery ≥ 7 days prior to the first dose of study medication
- * Has not recovered adequately (i.e., Grade ≥ 1 or baseline) from the toxicity and/or complications from any intervention prior to study start
- * Has a diagnosed additional malignancy within 3 years prior to first dose of study medication with the exception of curatively treated basal cell carcinoma of the skin, squamous cell carcinoma of the skin and/or curatively resected in situ cancers

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- * Has a known history of, or any evidence of, central nervous system (CNS) metastases and/or carcinomatous meningitis
- * Has a history of (non-infectious) pneumonitis that required steroids or current pneumonitis
- * Has an active infection requiring systemic therapy
- * Is pregnant or breast feeding or expecting to conceive or father starting from the first dose of study medication, throughout the study period, and for up to 120 days after the last dose of study medication
- * Has received prior immunotherapy with an anti-Programmed Cell Death Receptor 1 (PD-1), Programmed Cell Death Receptor Ligand 1 (anti-PD-L1), or anti-Programmed Cell Death Receptor Ligand 2 (PD-L2) or has previously participated in clinical studies with pembrolizumab
- * Has a known history of human immunodeficiency virus (HIV)
- * Has untreated active Hepatitis B
- * Has Hepatitis C in which participants received therapy for HCV ≤ 4 weeks prior to receiving pembrolizumab
- * Has received a live vaccine within 30 days prior to the first dose of study therapy

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID: 541362913489557453

Registry Number: NCT03062358

Sponsor: Merck

Study Title: Study of Pembrolizumab (MK-3475) or Placebo Given With Best Supportive Care in Asian Participants With Previously Treated Advanced Hepatocellular Carcinoma (MK-3475-394/KEYNOTE-394)

15. Sign-off & Approval

Principal Investigator: _____ Date: _____

Clinical Operations Lead: _____ Date: _____

Lead Statistician: _____ Date: _____